

FREE PRINTABLE

25 Things You're Forgetting to Clean

The spots holiday guests always notice, room by room, with the fastest fix for each one. Most take under five minutes.

Page two is the walkthrough: walk the house in that order with a cloth in hand and tick each spot off. The numbers match the items in the full guide, which has the why and the mistakes to avoid for every one.

The ten minute version

No time for all 25? These seven cover what guests notice most.

1. The doorbell and the front door
2. Light switches on the guest path
3. The ceiling fan over the seating area
4. The remote controls
5. The appliance handles
6. The toilet hinges and base
7. A fresh hand towel

What to use

You need almost nothing special.

Rubbing alcohol	switches, handles, remotes, anything electronic
White vinegar	hard water, showerheads, trash cans
Dish soap	grease, the top of the fridge, doors, baseboards
Hydrogen peroxide	toilet hinges, on a cotton swab
Microfiber cloths	everything else, dry on screens
Lint roller	lampshades and fabric

How often

So they stop being forgotten.

Weekly	switches, handles, remotes, the sponge, the hand towel
Monthly	fan blades, baseboards, lampshades, vents, tracks, the toaster tray, the trash can
Before guests	the whole list, starting with the bathroom

Work top to bottom

Dust falls.

1	Fan, then light fixture
2	Frames, shelves, lampshades
3	Switches, handles, surfaces
4	Baseboards, then the floor last

Notes

Finish with scent. A house that smells clean gets credit for being clean.

Entryway
FIRST IMPRESSIONS HAPPEN HERE

- [ ] 1 **Doorbell and front door**
  Damp cloth with a drop of dish soap on the button, the handle, and the stretch around it.
- [ ] 2 **Doormat**
  Shake it out, vacuum both sides, wash it if it is washable, sweep the floor underneath.
- [ ] 3 **Entry light switch**
  Cloth dampened with rubbing alcohol. Then every switch and handle on the guest path.
- [ ] 4 **Coat closet**
  Free up hangers, sort the shoe pile, vacuum the floor, wipe the shelf.

Living room
WHERE GUESTS SIT AND STARE

- [ ] 5 **Ceiling fan blades**
  Fan off. Pillowcase over each blade, pull it back so the dust stays inside.
- [ ] 6 **Baseboards**
  Vacuum with the brush, then a damp cloth with dish soap. Hallway and bathroom first.
- [ ] 7 **Remote controls**
  Batteries out, alcohol cloth all over, cotton swab between the buttons.
- [ ] 8 **Under the couch cushions**
  Cushions off, crevice tool along the seams, flip and rotate before they go back.
- [ ] 9 **Lampshades**
  Lint roller from the top down. Soft brush for pleats. Wipe the cool bulb.
- [ ] 10 **TV screen and picture frames**
  Dry microfiber only on the screen. Dust the top edge of every frame and mirror.
- [ ] 11 **Window and door tracks**
  Vacuum, old toothbrush with soapy water, cloth wrapped over a butter knife for the corners.
- [ ] 12 **Vent covers**
  System off. Wash the cover in the sink, dry it fully, wipe the streaks on the wall.

Dining room
EYE LEVEL CHANGES EVERYTHING

- [ ] 13 **Chair seats and rungs**
  Vacuum the seat seam, damp wipe the rungs and the back rail where hands pull.
- [ ] 14 **Light fixture over the table**
  Power off, dust top down, wash the glass shades, replace any dead bulb.
- [ ] 15 **Houseplant leaves**
  Damp cloth, support each leaf from underneath, both sides. Wipe the pot rim.

Kitchen
WHERE EVERYONE GATHERS ANYWAY

- [ ] 16 **Top of the fridge**
  Warm water with a squirt of dish soap cuts the sticky layer. Wipe what lives up there too.
- [ ] 17 **Appliance handles**
  Fridge, oven, microwave, dishwasher, undersides included. Then the stainless fronts with the grain.
- [ ] 18 **Toaster crumb tray**
  Unplug, slide out, dump, wipe. Shake the toaster over the sink.
- [ ] 19 **Sink drain and disposal**
  Scrub under the splash guard, ice and salt through the disposal, citrus peel. A day before, not the morning of.
- [ ] 20 **The sponge**
  Dishwasher on hot or two minutes in boiling water, or just put out a new one.
- [ ] 21 **The trash can itself**
  Rinse outside, hot soapy water, vinegar spray, dry in the sun. Paper in the bottom.

Bathroom
THE ROOM THEY INSPECT ALONE

- [ ] 22 **Toilet base, hinges, and behind**
  Pop the hinge caps, cotton swab with peroxide, floor behind with a cloth you use nowhere else.
- [ ] 23 **Faucet aerator and showerhead**
  Bag of vinegar over the showerhead overnight. Aerator soaks thirty minutes. Dry the chrome.
- [ ] 24 **Brush holder and plunger**
  Hot soapy water, an hour soak with vinegar, dry outside. Replace them if they are stained.
- [ ] 25 **Bath mat and hand towel**
  Wash both. Put the good towel out last, after your own hands are done.